Union Conference Record

"Be strong all ye people, saith the Lord, and work; for I am with you."

VOLUME VIII. September 1, 1904. Registered at the General Post Office, Sydney, for transmission by Post as a Newspaper NUMBER XVII.

THE ROYAL ORDER.

To THE front! the cry is ringing,
To the front! your place is there;
In the conflict men are wanted,
Men of hope, and faith, and prayer.
Selfish ends shall claim no right
From the battle-post to take us;
Fear shall vanish in the fight,
For triumphant, God will make us.

To the front! the fight is raging,
Christ's own banner leads the way,
Every power and thought engaging,
Might divine shall be our stay.
We have heard the cry for help,
From the dying millions 'round us;
We've received the royal order
From our Lord who found us.

To the front! no more delaying,
Wounded spirits need thy care;
To the front! thy Lord obeying,
Stop to help the dying there,
Broken hearts and blighted hopes,
Slaves of sin and degradation,
Wait for thee in love to living,
Holy peace and liberation.

—*Anon.*

A Remarkable Experience.

THE following correspondence, which came to us in the last American mail, was read in one of the meetings of the New South Wales Conference. It was greatly appreciated by those present, and we feel sure that it will be of interest to all our RECORD readers. The first is a letter to Sister White from Dr. Winegar Simpson, the wife of Elder Simpson referred to in the letter:—

DEAR SISTER WHITE,—

Knowing your interest in the work throughout the field, and especially the burden that you have carried for the work in Southern California, I write you that you may rejoice with us in the wonderful work our God is doing in warning the city of Los Angeles. For months past our church has felt that the time has come for the warning message to be given to this city. At the Conference in April, this was considered, and it was decided to put forth a strong effort here for about two months preceding the camp-meeting. The entire church seemed to feel the burden of this work, and for weeks—yes, months—earnest prayers have been offered that God would lead, even in the most minute details.

Elder Simpson was chosen to take charge of the work. It was thought best not to begin the work until after the fourth of July, so the tenth was set aside for the day for opening. Simpson's Auditorium, which has a seating capacity of two thousand, was secured for the first night. The meeting was thoroughly advertised throughout the city. The doors were to open at seven o'clock. There was to be a song service from seven-thirty till eight.

People began coming by seven, and by seven-thirty the building was well filled. At eight o'clock it was crowded even to the third gallery, and many were standing in the halls. Others came, and not being able to get in, went away.

Elder Simpson spoke on the "Millennium," or the "Binding of Satan." The interest was splendid. Before the service began, the minister who has charge of the Auditorium said to Elder Simpson, "It is a rare thing to have this building filled, and you need not expect that." After the meeting, he came again to Elder Simpson, and said, "This is marvellous. I never saw anything like it before."

Announcement was made of the meetings in the tent, which had been pitched in a central location. Some had thought a less expensive place, on the outskirts of the city, would do; but the majority of the church favored a good location, owing to the fact that some fanatical workers of the "holiness people," had recently held tent meetings with loud demonstration, which had disgusted the authorities. But we all prayed earnestly, and all the obstacles were removed.

The camp-meeting tent was put up, and about five hundred chairs placed for the first night. But hundreds were obliged to stand, and many could not get inside the tent.

The next day seats were put in for about three hundred more. Tuesday night the numbers had increased, and the seating capacity was still insufficient. Wednesday more seats were added, and still it was not sufficient. Yesterday we took down the tent, and added a twenty-foot extension, and rented three hundred more chairs. But even this was not sufficient; for every seat was filled last night, and a great number stood about the tent, not being able to get in.

It is thought that before Sunday, seats will have to be arranged in amphitheatre style, in order to accommodate the people. Those who are better judges of numbers of large audiences say there were at least three thousand people present last night. The greatest interest was manifested, and the Lord is using Elder Simpson to present His message in a very clear manner. The people are eagerly calling for literature, and a good supply is sold after each meeting.

The *Los Angeles Times* prints a synopsis of the sermon each day, and yesterday the *Examiner* gave a very good report. That in the *Times* is prepared by some of our own people, but that in the *Examiner* was by their regular reporter.

Surely such a work should be carried on in every city. We are all led to praise the Lord continually for the wonderful way in which He has answered prayer in behalf of this work. Yes; and He is answering prayer concerning the sanitarium work in this field. We hope to be able to write you very soon that we have a country sanitarium near Los Angeles, and we hope to be able to open it in a very few weeks. The building can be secured, and, in fact, is secured, providing the title can be cleared, and we believe it can; for God is working.

Means are coming in, and the light is surely breaking through after this long period of waiting. There is a good spirit in the work here, and we are of good courage. We are so thankful for the blessing of the Lord in our own home during the past few months. We feel that He is especially preparing us for service.

We are all glad to hear of the success of the work in Washington. Praying that the Lord will bless you and keep you,

I am,
Your sister in the blessed hope.
ABBIE WINEGAR SIMPSON.

Los Angeles, California, July 15, 1904.

We now give Sister White's reply to Dr. Simpson's letter. Much of this is of a general nature, and will prove a great blessing to all who heed it.

MY DEAR SISTER,—

To-day I received and read your very cheering letter. For the good news which it contained I praise our Lord and Saviour Jesus Christ. Your description of the work being done in Los Angeles agrees with the representations that God has given me. The delay in beginning this work has been very painful to me; but if the work is now

carried on in earnest faith, if the truth as it is in Jesus is magnified, if wise personal efforts are made, many souls will be brought from darkness to light. What a work might have been done many years ago! But I thank the Lord for the favorable beginning that has now been made.

In the visions of the night I was bearing a message to our churches, pointing out the work that as believers we should at once take up. I related some things that were presented to me in Nashville, just after I had returned from Huntsville.

A school for colored people is being carried on in Huntsville, but I was greatly pained while there to see the poverty-stricken condition of the institution. I knew from previous presentations, that this was displeasing to God, and that the school was not accomplishing that which He designed it to accomplish. I resolved to bear a plain, clear-cut testimony to our people, telling them that the money spent in the adornment of dress is a misappropriation of God's money, lent us to use in the advancement of His work.

Here are our ministers and physicians and missionaries. They labor hard and earnestly, but often they are greatly hindered in their work because the treasury is empty, and they cannot have the facilities necessary for the greatest success of their labors.

To us has been entrusted the work of proclaiming the last message of mercy to be given to our world,—the message that is to prepare a people to stand in the day of God. Do we realise our accountability? Are we acting our part in the proclamation of this message?

When I see our people spending money for needless trimmings, needless furnishings, I think of Jesus. He might have come to this world adorned with the glory of His kingly power. But He chose a life of self-denial and sacrifice. He came to this world in the garb of humanity. Those who follow in His footsteps will remember that every dollar they can spare is needed in the work that God has said shall be done in this world.

When our sisters are buying and making up their own and their children's garments, let them think of the work in the Lord's vineyard that is still waiting to be done. It is right to buy good material, and to have it carefully made. This is economy. But rich trimmings are not needed, and to indulge in them, is to spend for self-gratification money that should be put into God's cause.

My sisters, remember that Christ clothed His divinity with humanity, and came to this world to uplift fallen human beings, that they might stand on vantage ground, thus escaping the corruption that is in the world through lust. He gave His all to the work He came to do, and His word to us is, "If any man will come after Me, let him deny himself, and take up his cross, and follow Me." "So shall he be My disciple."

Remember, too, the words of the apostle: "Whose adorning, let it not be that outward adorning of plaiting the hair, and of wearing of gold, or of putting on of apparel; but let it be the hidden man of the heart, in that which is not corruptible, even the ornament of a meek and quiet spirit, which is in the sight of God of great price."

Let us take heed to God's words of warning, lest at any time we let them slip, and our hearts become evil hearts of unbelief. Just as soon as those who know the truth put away their unbelief, and practise the self-denial enjoined in the Word of God, the message will go with power. The Lord will hear our prayers for the conversion of souls. God's people will let their light shine forth, and unbelievers, seeing their good works, will glorify our Heavenly Father.

I call upon every church member to remember that we who are working in Washington are in need of your stretching your hands toward heaven, and pleading with the Lord to put His spirit upon every worker, imbuing them with His rich grace. Here is Elder Daniells bearing heavy responsibilities, and putting to the tax every power of mind and body to advance the work. He needs each day the healing, reviving power of the Holy Spirit. It is your prayers we need, as well as your gifts. Both are essential, but your prayers are of the greatest importance.

Do not let us forget God, but, like Joshua, who was placed at the head of a migrating nation, and was burdened with heavy responsibilities, resolve to serve God and Him alone. "As for me and my house," he declared, "we will serve the Lord."

We sincerely hope that in Southern California the work will make decided advancement. And I praise the Lord that those who have been carrying on sanitarium work in Los Angeles will soon be able to move into more comfortable quarters.

E. G. WHITE.

Takoma Park, Washington, D. C., July 22, 1904.

Our Mission Field.

Meeting in Eastern Polynesia.

ON the island of Raiatea, and up one of its lovely valleys hidden between high, picturesque mountains, and on the bank of a crystal mountain torrent, fed by many high cascades not far distant,—a fit place indeed to remind us of God's righteousness, which is like the great mountains,—was the place chosen for our Conference of the Eastern Polynesian Mission.

Here is the school farm which Brother Cady has begun with Sister Anna Nelson as teacher. One of our many considerations was that this ideal spot should be a missionary training home for native laborers, and it seemed to us no better place could be found for such a work.

All our discussions were directed to the one supreme end of speedily carrying the message to all places in this generation, and God witnessed to His approval of the meeting by blessing us abundantly with His Holy Spirit. It was felt by us to be the best we ever attended.

Brother Gates gave us most opportune lessons. The first Sabbath we met together, a tender feeling of repentance and weeping came upon all. It was remarked by an old resident that Raiatea had never before seen such a meeting. The same tender Spirit was present all through, and a hearty praise meeting closed the Conference. The following Sabbath, five young people were baptised, one of whom was a little native boy from our Rarotongan school, and whom we left at Raiatea with Sister Nelson. We then separated to our respective fields of labor, feeling thankful for the spiritual blessings we received, and renewed with strength to "press the battle to the gate."

G. F. JONES.

July 24, 1904.

Eastern Polynesian Mission Conference.

Chairman's Opening Address.

THE following is an abridged report of the opening address of Pastor B. J. Cady, chairman of the Eastern Polynesian Mission, at the Conference held in Raiatea, Society Islands, July 7-18. Later issues of the RECORD will give a report of the doings of the Conference.

E. H. GATES.

DEAR BRETHREN AND SISTERS,—

We are glad to meet you in our annual gathering. During the past year, we have seen many evidences of God's care for His people and work here in the islands, as well as in the world at large.

At our last meeting, the plan was conceived to unite the interests of the various islands in this part of the Pacific, that we might be better able to assist one another in devising plans and raising funds for the carrying forward of the Third Angel's Message in this part of the world. An organisation was therefore formed, and called the Eastern Polynesian Mission.

The various churches included in the organisation seemed pleased, after it was understood by them, and many have looked forward with pleasure to this present Conference meeting.

As we see how rapidly the prophecies are being fulfilled, we can better realise the importance of pressing forward as never before, and also the importance of every Seventh-day Adventist being fully converted, and consecrated to the work of carrying the Third Angel's Message to all the world. We must have men and women whose hearts are filled with earnestness and devotion to take this gospel everywhere. True soldiers of the cross, who hate covetousness, who will deny self, and bind about their own wants while they give to help others, are needed.

We must realise as a people that God calls each one of us to enlist as a soldier for Christ in this closing work. As it takes money to carry forward this work, all

should be taught the importance of heeding God's command to bring all the tithe into the store house, as well as offerings. Those who have children and youth in their homes, should understand the importance of educating them for God's service, that they may help to swell the army of workers for the Lord.

During the past year, our laborers have usually enjoyed good health. We expect to have an opportunity during this meeting to hear from each individual worker, in regard to his work of the past year. Not all that was planned for has been accomplished, but some encouraging results can be seen of the work done. Brother Jones and wife have spent most of the time in the Cook Islands, where a church has been built and dedicated. Sister Gooding has been busily engaged in school work on the island of Rarotonga. Brother Roth has spent his time in Tahiti working for the French people. Sister Nelson has been busy in the Home at Avera, Raiatea, looking after the religious, industrial, and educational interests of the place. Brother Beckner and wife, who have been connected with the Home at Avera, have recently moved to Papeete, and now have charge of the store and bakery there. Sister Lydia Parker has devoted her time to distributing reading matter, holding Bible readings, and caring for the sick. A few months ago, she received a call to nurse in the Government hospital in Papeete. After much prayer, she decided to accept of the opening, feeling that God's providence might be in it, and a wider field of usefulness be opened before her. We are glad to say that her services seem to be appreciated, and can only hope that much good may come from her being connected with that place. Mrs. Cady has spent the most of her time translating and copying our Sabbath-school lessons in the Tahitian language, and getting out readings for the benefit of our Tahitian brethren. This, with her bookkeeping and other work, has kept her very busy.

I have visited our various churches in Tahiti and Raiatea at different times. The first of October, I left for Mangareva and Pitcairn Island. We had some interesting meetings in these places. The church on Pitcairn Island voted to show their willingness to carry out the wishes of the Australasian Union Conference, and to send to them their tithes and offerings through the Tahitian Mission, according to the suggestion of Superintendent Gates and Sister Graham, treasurer of the Australasian Union Conference.

Eleven have been baptised in territory included in the Tahitian Mission during the past year. We are sorry to report that some have had to be disfellowshipped. It is indeed sad to see coming in among God's professed followers a spirit of conformity to the world. How can we arouse our people to come out from the world and be separate? The command is, "Arise and shine, for thy light is come."

The tithe received by the Tahitian Mission during the year 1903, was $552.18. From June 30, 1903, to June 30, 1904, $165.48 tithe was received by the Cook Island Mission. The Sabbath-school donations and other offerings have increased during the past year, we having received during 1903, the sum of $61.77 from Tahiti and Raiatea, and $36.71 from Pitcairn and Mangareva. We are glad to see the willingness on the part of some to give of their means, to help advance the Lord's work in the earth, but we would that all might see the importance of returning to the Lord His own, that many new laborers might be sent forth into the wide harvest field.

I would suggest the following subjects for consideration at this Conference:—

1. The importance of Seventh-day Adventists having a true understanding of our relationship to the Testimonies of the Spirit of God.
2. Tithing—What is it? Are any exempt from it? When should we pay tithe?
3. Temperance in eating and drinking.
4. Church discipline.
5. Sabbath-school work.
6. Missionary work at home and abroad.
7. The book "Christ Our Saviour" in Tahitian.
8. Young people's work.
9. Education of our children.
10. Entering new fields during the coming year.
11. The probability of getting a missionary boat to assist our workers in reaching out-of-the-way places.

We hope that all of these matters may be considered by our Conference, and such actions taken as may be blessed of God.

City or Country Life—Which?

LET those who like best to live in the city, consider for a few moments some of the advantages of a certain sweet, quiet home amidst the beauties of nature.

This home is situated in a beautiful valley of Raiatea, one of the Society Islands. It is surrounded by high mountains covered with trees, ferns, and rocks of many descriptions. In the valleys, rivers and waterfalls make their musical sounds. Not far away is the sea. The house is built under the brow of a hill on which grow mangoes, oranges, and beautiful cocoanut palms. Immediately below the back yard flows a clear, delightful stream, supplying all the water necessary for house-keeping, as well as providing several swimming pools for those who take pleasure in this splendid recreation. Much of the food used in the home grows on the plantation connected with it. There are several varieties of bananas, mangoes, oranges, limes, nitas, mape nuts, and cocoanuts, which supply oil, butter, cream, and milk for the family. Sugar-cane also is grown, from which both sugar and treacle are made. Other things such as legumes and vegetables are grown at the pleasure of those connected with the farm. Fowls are kept, too, which, besides supplying nice fresh eggs, also afford sport to the younger members of the family who go nest hunting. Bees also add their sweetness to the rest of the good things produced. Besides all this there is an abundance of good wood, which we all know is an article of great expense to those living in the city. Oranges, sugar, treacle, etc, are sold, which bring in a little income.

It is not an ordinary family that lives on this beautiful farm. There is no real mother or father; and the children are not all brothers and sisters. The teacher, a Christian young lady, presides in the home, and is as a mother to the boys and girls who go there for a Christian training. The oversight of all is in the hands of a missionary and his wife.

The writer has recently spent a few weeks at this place, and it seems as though the sweet peace of God rests upon all who dwell there. Everywhere one may look, nature seems to say, "God is love." Never, perhaps, could there be found a more suitable place in which to train young people both for the duties of life as well as for the service of God.

EVELYN GOODING.

THE PUREST JOY.

If I can live
To make some pale face brighter,
And to give a second lustre to
Some tear-dimmed eye,

Or e'en impart
One throb of comfort to an
Aching heart, or cheer some way
Worn soul in passing by;

If I can lend
A strong hand to the fallen,
Or defend the right against
A single envious strain,

My life, though bare,
Perhaps of much that seemeth
Dear and fair to us on earth, will
Not have been in vain.

The purest joy
Most near to heaven, far from
Earth's alloy, is bidding clouds
Give way to sun and shine.

And 'twill be well
If on that day of days the angels
Tell of me: "She did her best
For one of Thine."

—*Selected.*

"HE who waits to do a great deal of good at once will never do any."

"KIND looks, kind words, kind acts, and warm hand-shakes—these are the secondary means of grace when men are in trouble and are fighting their unseen battles."

The New South Wales Conference.

THE ninth annual session of the New South Wales Conference was held in the Stanmore Church, August 17-22, 1904. Representatives from nine of the churches within the Conference were present, the roll call being responded to by forty-one delegates: an attendance of thirty out of thirty-eight appointed delegates, and eleven delegates at large.

Two churches had been organised in the Conference since the last meeting at Bathurst,—Orange and Blayney, the number of churches within the Conference now numbering sixteen.

The report of the President told of the work in Bathurst, Millthorpe, Molong, Manildra, and the Manning River District. At Bathurst a church building is being completed, and a company of twenty are awaiting organisation. During the fiscal year 1903-1904 there has been an addition of one hundred and thirty in church membership, while four ministers, three licentiate preachers, and seven Bible workers have been engaged in field work generally.

Financial statements and reports were presented by the Conference and Tract Society officers, which showed that there had been faithful work done, often through trying circumstances. The Conference treasurer's report showed that there had been a deficit for the year of £25 15s 3d. The total tithe and donations for the year amounted to £1,402 4s 10d, while the sum of £1,422 16s 1½d had been expended in Conference work.

The missionary report of the Tract Society showed that there had been considerable done in the way of missionary correspondence. Many interesting letters had been received from persons expressing appreciation of the efforts put forth in their behalf. The local missionary societies had distributed in different ways about 1,400 *Signs* weekly. Our Young People's Societies are actively engaged in various lines of missionary work, and the Ship Mission work is receiving some attention. The total amount of Fourth Sabbath Donations to missions during the year was £84 5s, while the Annual Offerings during the week of prayer amounted to £109 13s. With brighter prospects of better harvests, the work of the canvasser is materially improving, as shown by the summaries of orders taken during the last months of the year.

The following committees were appointed:—

ON PLANS AND RECOMMENDATIONS: G. S. Fisher, J. M. Johanson, E. M. Graham, P. H. Lloyd, Mrs. A. L. Hindson.

ON NOMINATIONS: J. Hindson, A. Davis, E. Davey.

ON CREDENTIALS AND LICENSES: G. A. Irwin, P. B. Rudge, J. J. Paap.

ON AUDITING: F. L. Sharp, A. R. Sherwin, H. James, G. R. Sotheren, M. Lackey, W. Harrison, to act with the Conference Committee.

The following report was presented by the Committee on Credentials and Licenses, and adopted:—

FOR CREDENTIALS: S. M. Cobb, G. B. Starr, J. L. McElhany, F. W. Paap.

FOR LICENSES: W. J. McGowan, G. W. Tadich, Joseph Mills.

FOR MISSIONARY LICENSES: P. B. Rudge, G. G. James, Miss A. E. Pearce, Mrs. T. A. Chapman, Mrs. G. B. Starr, Miss H. R. Pearce, Miss R. Cozens.

The Committee on Nominations presented the following report, which was adopted:—

FOR PRESIDENT: S. M. Cobb.

FOR VICE-PRESIDENT: J Hindson.

FOR SECRETARY AND TREASURER: C. H. Schowe.

FOR EXECUTIVE COMMITTEE: S. M. Cobb, J. Hindson, G. B. Starr, P. B. Rudge, George Fisher.

FOR TRACT SOCIETY SECRETARY AND TREASURER: Miss A. S. Higgins.

FOR ASSISTANT SECRETARY: C. H. Schowe.

FOR STATE CANVASSING AGENT: P. B. Rudge.

FOR SABBATH-SCHOOL SECRETARY: Miss A. E. Pearce.

FOR EDUCATIONAL SECRETARY: Miss Hattie Andre.

THE following report was presented by Committee on Plans and Recommendations, and adopted:—

1. *We recommend*, That during the coming year the officers of the Conference and Tract Society make a special effort to carry out recommendations numbers four, five, six, and seven, passed at the Bathurst Camp Meeting.

2. That special plans be laid by the standing committee on "Christ's Object Lessons" work (which consists of the President of the Conference, and the Secretary and General Agent of the Tract Society) for bringing the sale of this book to a speedy completion.

3. *We recommend*, That a Canvassers' Convention and Institute be held in the State during the coming Conference year, that provision be made to give instruction in the best methods of circulating our literature, that time be devoted to studying principles of present truth, and that arrangements be made for giving instruction in simple hygienic treatments.

4. Recognising the value of the Café as a means of bringing the principles of present truth before a class of people difficult to reach in any other way,—

We recommend, That the missionary effort put forth in this institution receive the hearty co-operation of our people, by the circulation of literature provided by the Café and by personal work with friends and neighbors.

5. *We recommend*, That in harmony with the recommendation of the Union Conference, a district Director be appointed as soon as practicable to have the general oversight of church interests and aggressive missionary work, acting under the supervision of the Conference, and paid by the Conference.

6. *We recommend*, That more close attention be given to the instruction given in the "Testimonies" in reference to the selection of agents, and that the General Agent counsel with the Tract Society officers and such members of the Conference Committee as are available, in the selection of workers for the field.

7. Recognising that the adoption of the salesman's and delivery contracts has already resulted in benefit to our Tract Society and canvassing work,—

We recommend, That our Tract Society officers in their dealings with the field, work strictly to the principles embodied in these contracts, and that special care be exercised to secure prompt returns from the field.

8. *We recommend*, That the churches in this Conference be grouped in districts, and that our State Tract Society officers with the State Sabbath-school Secretary plan for missionary and Sabbath-school Conventions to be held in each district as often as once a quarter.

The meeting adjourned *sine die*.

S. M. COBB,
President.

C. H. SCHOWE,
Secretary.

The Message in Yangan.

GOOD meetings have been held in this place, crowds of people being greatly interested in the truth presented. The black-board was freely used in order to make the truth so simple that a child might understand it. Many of the people gave up their habits of smoking, seeing our bodies are the temple of the living God.

After presenting the message here, we decided to hold a series of meetings four miles away, at Swanfells. At this place we were visited by a plague of mice, which proved very troublesome. It was mice in the food boxes, mice in the beds, mice in the clothes, in fact, mice everywhere. The blankets were literally riddled with holes, hats were treated badly, and song books suffered severely. After making a trap, no less than seventy-three of the rodents

were caught in the small tent in one week. One of our neighbors who accepted the truth has caught an average of sixty a night for the past fortnight.

Though Satan seeks to hinder the work of God, yet the Third Angel's Message progresses, and is going in the spirit and the power of Elijah.

About nineteen souls have accepted the truth in Yangan and vicinity, who will hold up the glorious light of this message. Much opposition had to be overcome, the enemy of souls working insidiously to draw them away. D. M. Canright's book has been in circulation freely, but thanks be unto God, not one soul has been drawn away by it.

Yours in the work,

A. SMART.

Effort with "Rights of Man" in South Australia.

THOSE of our people who read the UNION CONFERENCE RECORD (and we trust that all do) will perhaps remember that at the meeting of the South Australian Conference held in November of last year, the following recommendation was passed:—

That our State Tract Society secretary take steps to place the book "Rights of Man" in the hands of members of Parliament, barristers, teachers, and other leading men, as a means of education in right principles of religious liberty, and that a united effort be made to give this book a wide circulation throughout the field.

In endeavoring to carry out this recommendation, an appeal was made to the churches and individuals throughout the Conference, asking them to contribute to a fund from which we could draw in order to supply our prominent men with a copy of the book. In response to the appeal, donations amounting to £7 10s were received at the office of the Tract Society. Letters were written to the members of Parliament of both houses, the judges, some of the leading lawyers, and the editors of the newspapers, advising them that we were presenting them with a copy of the book, and requesting that it be given a careful reading.

It was thought that the Kensington Church Missionary Society would enjoy spending an evening in preparing the books and letters for the post, so these were sent to the church, and on the Sabbath, announcement was made that the following evening—the evening of missionary meeting, would be devoted to something practical. Quite a large number were present on the occasion, and after singing an appropriate hymn, the Lord's blessing was invoked upon the books as they should come to the hands of those for whom they were intended. Then the work began, and went forward cheerfully.

Both young and old were given something to do. One prepared the wrappers by pasting the edges, others wrapped the books, some who wrote a good hand addressed them, while the stamps were affixed by others. Then came the letters: they were folded, and placed in the envelopes which were then addressed and stamped by willing workers. Altogether 110 books, each accompanied by a letter, have been sent out, and as a result of this effort, we trust that many will become acquainted with the principles of religious liberty as outlined in the "Rights of Man."

For some time the Kensington Church has been holding Sabbath afternoon meetings at which the principles of religious liberty have been studied, taking "Rights of Man" as a text-book. Those who attend the studies claim that they find them intensely interesting, and this, perhaps, would account for the interest manifested in preparing the books to be sent out.

On the first page of the *Signs*, date July 11, there is an account of one of our Victorian brethren being summoned to appear in court and being fined for working on Sunday. The voice of the dragon is being heard, and it is important that the principles underlying this great question be studied carefully by us as a people, so that should we be brought before magistrates, the Holy Spirit can bring to our remembrance the truths learned, and thus enabling us to give a reason for the hope that is in us with meekness and fear.

R. H. CONSTANDT.

YOUR CALL.

THE world is dark, but you are called to brighten
Some little corner, some secluded glen;
Somewhere a burden rests that you may lighten,
And thus redect the Master's love for men.

Is there a brother drifting on life's ocean,
Who might be saved if you but speak a word?
Speak it to-day. The testing of devotion
Is our response when duty's call is heard.

—*Christian Advocate.*

Union Conference Council,
Held at Avondale, August 4-8.

THE School and people at Avondale were pleased that it was decided to hold a portion of this year's council at Avondale.

It is always encouraging to meet our brethren fresh from the field of conflict, to look into their faces, and to listen to their reports of progress and words of exhortation. Father Time is whitening the hair of some of these faithful workers.

All of the members of the Committee attended the chapel exercises, and addressed the students. Some forcible illustrations were used by the speakers, which served to fasten the lessons in the mind. The students will not soon forget the call for laborers who can endure hardships, by Brother Hennig; illustrated by the young tent master, who, when the storm came and the tent was shaken, thought he was needed at home. Men and women are wanted who are not afraid of storm or hard work.

The School, as a workshop for shaping and polishing rough stones, and knocking off prominent corners, thus fitting them for their place in God's building, was presented by Brother Salisbury. Character building was forcibly illustrated by Brother M. Hare. Honest shipbuilders put good timbers in every part, and copper bolts that will stand the salt water. But the avaricious ones, for the sake of gain, will put in inch boards where there should be two-inch, and two-inch timbers where four-inch ones are called for, and iron bolts instead of copper. But in the strain of the storm the unfaithful work gives way, and the vessel goes down, and precious lives are lost. So in character building it pays to put in good material and to see that every part is strong.

On Friday evening, Pastor Nellis of Queensland spoke in the College chapel. He delivered a powerful discourse on death to self and a present resurrection with Jesus Christ to a life of victory over every sin.

On Sabbath morning, Brother J. Pallant of West Australia spoke in the power of the Spirit on "The exceeding greatness of His power to usward who believe" to deliver from the bondage of sin. "Able to save" and "able to keep" was the keynote of the meetings.

To very many of us it seems clear

that the time has come for the spiritual deliverance of God's people. This deliverance must precede the physical at Christ's second coming. Before probation closes, Christ's work in our behalf must reach the point of eternal deliverance from all sin. God's people must stand without an intercessor, and before His intercessions cease, the last sin from the last sinner must be removed and its power forever broken.

We have been in the Wilderness of Sin long enough. Let the word be sounded all along the line, "LET MY PEOPLE GO, THAT THEY MAY SERVE ME." Let Pharaoh and all his host be drowned in the Red Sea of Christ's blood, and let us voice the shout of victory through Jesus Christ our Leader. Let us believe in the gospel that has full salvation in it for all who will believe.

G. B. STARR.

Our Canvassers.

JUST WHERE THOU ART.

JUST where thou art lift up thy voice,
And sing the song that stirs thy heart;
Reach forth thy strong and eager hand
To lift, to save, just where thou art.
Just where thou standest, light thy lamp;
'Tis dark to others as to thee;
Their ways are hedged by unseen thorns,
Their burdens fret as thine fret thee.

Out yonder in the broad, full glare
Of many lamps thine own might pale,
And thy sweet song amid the roar
Of many voices slowly fail;
While these thy kindred wandered on
Uncheered, unlighted to the end.
Near to thy hand thy mission lies—
Wherever sad hearts need a friend.

—*Selected.*

Monthly Summary of Australasian Canvassing Work.

South Australia.

JULY, 1904.

	Hrs.	Ord.	Value.	
Home Hand Book—				
L. A. Apollon, Hawker	100	13	20	0 0
Desire of Ages—				
L. W. Gericke, Kochunga	75	5	5	11 6
Mrs. Gericke, "	40	4	2	4 0
Great Controversy—				
F. W. Behrens, Lobethal	31	4	2	10 0
Daniel and Revelation—				
J. L. Branford, Augaston	106	26	18	3 0
J. J. Potter, "	104	13	9	13 6
A. N. Lawson, Broken Hill	79	18	12	16 0
Ladies' Guide—				
Mrs. Arnold, Ardrossan	53	5	5	2 0
Miss Roesner, Ardrossan	53	5	5	15 0
House We Live In—				
Miss Kildael, Paynehan	38	12	2	14 0
Miss Woodford, Paynehan	38	12	2	14 0
Miss Steed, Thebarton	7	3	0	13 6
Miscellaneous	...	11	9	6 6
Helps Sold by Agents			8	2 0
	724	131	£105	3 0

Queensland.

JULY, 1904.

	Hrs.	Ord.	Value	
Home Hand Book—				
J. H. Hewitt, Harrisville	77	22	£36	10 0
Miss H. Cozens, Rockhampton	...	1	1	10 0
F. Albon, Warwick	188	21	31	10 0
A. W. Horwood, Wide Bay	65	5	8	0 0
P. Reekie, Mackay	...	14	21	0 0
A. Costello, Charters Towers	68	3	5	0 0
Ladies' Guide—				
Q'land Tract Society, Toowong	15	4	4	0 0
Mrs. Morrison, South Brisbane	...	10	10	0 0
A. Costello, Charters Towers	...	1	1	0 0
Miss Amy Cozens, Toowong	44	8	8	0 0
Mrs. Richardson, Brisbane	1	1	1	0 0
Miss H. Cozens, Rockhampton	74	23	23	0 0
Daniel & Revelation—				
W. Patava, Oakey & Pittsworth	95	5	3	2 6
B. Cozens, Gin Gin & Kolan R.	102	31	21	7 6
Miscellaneous	17	4	3	0 6
Patriarchs and Prophets—				
A. Start, Cairns	133	33	19	12 0
Miss A. Patava, Crow's Nest	26	4	2	17 6
Christ Our Saviour—				
A. Start, Cairns	...	13	3	10 6
House We Live In—				
Miss Albon, Warwick	8	4	0	18 0
Great Controversy—				
A. Costello, Charters Towers	...	1	1	0 0
Helps Sold by Agents			7	9 8
	853	208	£213	8 2

New South Wales.

JULY, 1904.

	Hrs.	Ord.	Value.	
Coming King—				
A. E. Hodgkison, Tamworth	110	74	£32	14 0
" " " (Other Books)	...	...	5	13 0
Geo. Wood, Tamworth	96	27	10	16 0
F. Parkin, Tamworth	68	33	14	18 6
W. Harrison, Parramatta	98	36	16	19 0
F. Hedges, Armidale	...	3	1	17 6
J. Mitchell May, Cobar	...	4	6	15 0
A. Potter, Cowra	96	34	14	12 0
Daniel and Revelation—				
R. Salton, Newcastle	122	19	13	13 0
C. E. Harlow, Newcastle	147	15	10	6 0
W. R. Lamb, Newcastle	44	5	4	8 6
Bible Readings—				
Allan Wood, Junee	104	54	43	11 0
Mrs. A. Wood, "	23	8	5	3 6
Patriarchs & Prophets—				
J. H. Thompson, Condobolin	130	5	5	17 6
Home Hand Book—				
M. A. Connell, Richmond R.	59	4	6	0 0
G. A. March, Brunswick R.	143	20	32	8 3
Ladies' Guide—				
Mrs. Gregg, Hornsby Dist.	100	23	23	10 0
Mrs. Wheat, Dulwich Hill	42	5	5	7 6
Mrs. Williams, Annandale	50	15	15	0 0
Man the Masterpiece—				
H. E. Hughes, Penrith	40	4	5	0 0
House We Live In—				
Miss Lambert, Parramatta	69	14	3	3 0
Helps Sold by Agents			25	7 3
	1645	437	£308	18 6

Tasmania.

JULY, 1904.

	Hrs.	Ord.	Value.	
Home Hand Book—				
N. Kennan	82	20	£30	10 0
B. Worth	141	22	33	0 0
Coming King—				
E. R. Voss	80	8	4	6 0
M. Voss	97	14	7	11 0
Helps Sold by Agents	...	...	4	8 0
	400	64	£79	15 0

West Australia.

JULY, 1904.

	Hrs.	Ord.	Value.	
Coming King—				
A. W. Nock, S. W. Line	120	37	£15	16 6
Great Controversy—				
Wm. Morris Midland Rly.	39	8	6	0 0
F. Masters, Kalgoorlie	25	6	3	15 0
Home Hand Book—				
F. Masters, Kalgoorlie	25	3	6	0 0
Christ Our Saviour—				
F. Masters, Kalgoorlie	...	2	0	9 0
House We Live in—				
F. Masters, Kalgoorlie	...	2	0	9 0
Miss Dawkins, Perth	44	20	4	10 0
Miss M. Dawkins, Subiaco	31	18	3	13 0
Helps Sold by Agents			2	14 9
	284	96	£43	7 3

New Zealand.

JULY, 1904.

	Hrs.	Ord.	Value.	
Coming King—				
D. M. Adam, Nelson	136	66	£33	16 0
H. Blunden, Timaru	83	114	65	0 0
J. A. Macintosh, Timaru	58	21	10	11 0
W. G. Washer, Patea, Taranaki	67	16	10	0 0
Desire of Ages—				
A. G. Mackenzie, Te Roti; Etc.	77	28	32	0 0
W. J. Redhead, Gore, Otago	23	5	6	10 0
C. Reynolds, Oamaru, Otago	148	33	42	10 0
Patriarchs and Prophets—				
W. W. Ward, Fielding	58	13	8	17 0
Daniel and Revelation—				
W. Codling, Tai Tapu, Cant'b'y	28	9	5	16 0
Home Hand Book—				
G. Masters, Fielding	47	3	6	0 0
J. A. Macintosh, Timaru	...	1	1	10 0
Ladies' Guide—				
Mrs. Masters, Fielding	64	17	19	5 0
House We Live In—				
Miss Candy, Linwood, Ch'ch.	10	5	1	2 6
Miscellaneous	...	...	3	10 0
Helps Sold by Agents			18	5 6
	794	331	£264	13 0

Victoria.

JULY, 1904.

	Hrs.	Ord.	Value	
Home Hand Book—				
H. C. Harker, Willenabrina	...	38	£59	10 0
" (Other Books)	...	17	9	3 6
G. Burgess, Thoona	78	24	41	0 0
J. B. Anderson, Casterton	...	16	27	0 0
A. N. Harker, Beulah	21	7	11	0 0
" (Other Books)	...	5	2	15 0
Great Controversy—				
B. Judge, Murtoa	89	19	12	17 6
" (Other Books)	...	1	0	4 6
L. Coyte, Murtoa	104	18	12	7 0
C. P. Michaelis, Melbourne	...	26	11	17 0
W. Edwards, Murtoa	45	8	5	5 0
" (Other Books)	...	6	1	7 0
Coming King—				
H. H. Cordell, Kerang	130	40	18	14 0
W. Edwards, Great Western	67	24	10	3 0
W. Ryder, Emu Creek	83	17	8	11 6
House We Live in—				
Miss M. Barlow, Malvern	93	31	6	7 6
" Albert Park	80	25	18	14 6
Miscellaneous	90	22	16	6 6
Helps Sold by Agents			9	13 9
	880	344	£282	17 3

Totals for July, 1904.

	Hours.	Orders.	Value	
West Australia	284	96	£43	7 3
New South Wales	1645	437	308	18 6
South Australia	724	131	105	3 0
Victoria	880	344	282	17 3
New Zealand	794	331	264	13 0
Tasmania	400	64	79	15 0
Queensland	853	208	213	8 2
Grand Total	5580	1611	1298	2 2

A Touching Appeal.

PASTOR MUNSON, our missionary in Sumatra, lays before us the sad case of Matthew, a Chinese convert to the faith in that field, and his seven half-orphan children. Pastor Munson says that at one time Matthew was the richest man in the district, but that he was defrauded of his property. At the time of his baptism his relatives forsook him altogether, and for a long time Pastor Munson kept him from starving. For a year and a half he has been at Bencoolen, where a nephew gives him 150 pounds of rice a month and three quarts of kerosene oil. Matthew recently had a stroke of paralysis, and it was thought that he could not survive. Brother Munson visited him at this time, and describes the situation as follows:—

I found him in a most pitiable condition, and weeping bitterly over his hard fortune. What distressed him most was the thought of his family of seven children unprovided for, and certain to be scattered among his heathen relatives, and treated as slaves, and brought up as heathen.

After returning home, I could not get those seven children out of my mind or heart, and Mrs. Munson and I prayed and talked much over the question of what was our duty as a church to the orphans of Christian parents, for it is a matter of only a few months probably when Matthew's children will become full orphans. Our hearts were greatly distressed at the thought of what must befall them if we did nothing to rescue them.

I have appealed to different brethren at home to help me undertake the support and education of these children. I estimate that the two older girls will require about £1 a month, and the five boys 12/6 each, or a total of £5 a month to rent a house, furnish it, employ a widow who believes, and is only waiting for some chance to cut loose from her family in order to be baptised, to take care of them. Then we must have a school for Christian children only.

Can you do anything to help us? Are there not some individual churches or brethren who could undertake the support of one boy? Perhaps two or three persons uniting could take one, and send the money through the Union Conference. The Spirit of Prophecy makes our duty plain, it appears to me, in regard to the orphans of our own people. See Testimonies, Vol. VI, pages 281 to 287. Note particularly pages 286 and 287.

Are there not some in this field who would like to have a part in this worthy enterprise? Perhaps some of our Young People's Societies will want to undertake the support of one or more of these children. We can think of no cause more fitting or worthy of our help. Brother Munson says that no mission work in those lands pays such large returns as the care of the children. He cites the case of Timothy as an illustration. They took him into their family, and supported and taught him, and now he is developing into a grand worker for Christ. He says that these five boys under consideration may turn out in the same way in a few years' time.

"Signs" Circulation for Year Ending June 30, 1904.

State.	Circulation for the Year.	Average per week.	Camp-meeting Nos.	Special Nos.
N. Zealand	149,695	2,879	.....	18,547
Victoria	104,265	2,005	3,000	100,209
N. S. Wales	71,698	1,379	1,500	14,761
W. Australia	52,629	1,012	.....	6,007
Queensland	43,360	834	.....	4,794
S. Australia	35,315	679	2,000	11,513
Tasmania	27,302	525	.....	2,160
Foreign	4,694	90	.....	.....
Miscellaneous	5,028	96	.....	.....
Missions	6,000	115	.....	.....
TOTALS	499,986	9,614	6,500	157,991
GRAND TOTAL	664,477.			

Awake, Awake, Awake.

WE face a cunning foe, and the deceitfulness of sin is very great. We are not safe merely because we acknowledge the meaning of the tokens of the great day, now so abundant. There is the greatest danger lest we should be overcome by the seductive influences of the hour, and fall asleep on Satan's enchanted ground. "Awake, awake, put on thy strength, O Zion." "Awake, thou that sleepest, and arise from the dead, and Christ shall shine upon thee." "It is time for you to awake out of sleep; for now is salvation nearer to us than when we first believed." "Could the curtains be rolled back, could you discern the purposes of God and the judgments that are about to fall upon a doomed world, could you see your own attitude, you would fear, and tremble for your own souls and for the souls of your fellowmen. Earnest prayers of heart-rending anguish would go up to heaven. You would weep between the porch and the altar, confessing your spiritual blindness and backsliding." Awake, awake, awake.

W. W. PRESCOTT.

"THE Lamb is slain, the Sacrifice immortal,
Whose life received creates the soul anew;
His blood is shed,—but is it on the portal?
O haste and see! doth it avail for you?"

Notes and Personals.

BROTHER A. DAVIS of Cooranbong has been appointed by the Avondale School as superintendent of the School farm.

THE annual meeting of the Echo Publishing Company will be held in the North Fitzroy Church at 7 P. M., September 6.

BY the *Signs* summary on this page it will be seen that the average weekly circulation for the year has reached almost 10,000 copies.

BROTHER METCALF HARE has been appointed manager of the Health Food Factory at Cooranbong, and Brother M. D. Rogers field agent for the health foods.

THE New South Wales Conference was held according to appointment in the Stanmore Church, beginning August 17. We give a report of the proceedings elsewhere.

SISTER ELLA HAWKINS left on the *S. S. Oonah*, August 24, for Tasmania. After spending a few weeks with relatives in Hobart, she will go on to Launceston to enter upon her work as Secretary of the Tract Society.

BROTHER and Sister Robie with their two adopted children sailed for the United States via England on the *S. S. Persic*. After having spent about five years in this field, they are returning home at the earnest solicitation of Brother Robie's aged parents.

IF any have clean tracts or copies of the *Signs* and *Good Health* to spare, and would like to send them to Brother L. Currow at Suva Vou, Fiji, they will be very acceptable to him, and can be used to good advantage in his work.

BROTHER and Sister W. R. Carswell, with their daughter Nettie, arrived in Sydney from Melbourne on Friday, August 26. Brother and Sister Carswell come to New South Wales to labor in harmony with the action taken at the recent Conference meeting, inviting them to this field.

PASTOR F. W. PAAP was in attendance at the New South Wales Conference. On Sunday afternoon, August 21, he gave an interesting account of the work in Bathurst, and at the close of the meeting an opportunity was given to contribute toward the new church building in Bathurst. About £14 was raised in cash and pledges to be paid by September 15.

"IT has been well said that no man ever sank under the burden of the day. It is when to-morrow's burden is added to the burden of to-day that the weight is more than a man can bear."

Union Conference Record

PUBLISHED SEMIMONTHLY BY THE

Australasian Union Conference of Seventh Day Adventists.

32 Royal Chambers, Castlereagh St., Sydney, N. S. W., Australia.

SUBSCRIPTION RATES.

Single subscription, per year, post-paid, - 2 6
Foreign Countries, per year, post-paid (75 cts.) 3 0

Printed for the Conference by the Avondale Press Cooranbong, N.S.W.

THE special Sabbath-school donation for Sabbath, September 24, is to be given toward a much needed church building in Sumatra. Please read the following description of the situation there by Pastor Munson, and let your donations on that day be liberal.

A Church Building for Sumatra.

WE have reached a point where it becomes necessary to erect a small house of worship with rooms attached for our native preacher. It is important that we have a visible, tangible sign of our permanence and stability. There are a number of Chinese people who are interested, and who would like to join us, but who are greatly troubled with a fear that we may some day get up and leave them without any pastoral oversight and nobody to bury them. This is a very serious question with every Chinaman. They invariably ask, "If I die, who will bury me?" "If we become Christians, will the work be *permanent?*"

Sister Sarah, who is seventy-five, or nearly that, of whom I spoke in my last report, said to Mrs. Munson not long since, "I used often to ask myself, 'If I die, who will carry me to my burial?' But now, when I see all these Singke brothers coming to our services, and interested in the gospel, I say, 'Ah, these are the men who will help to bury me.'" When they see us building, their faith and confidence will be greatly strengthened.

And so we hear a voice saying, "Arise, and build." We have little funds, but large faith. *The Lord will surely help us.* On a recent Sabbath we explained our purpose, and received in offerings £1 8s. Most of this was second tithe given by ourselves. There are £6, raised three years ago for helping to buy a piece of land for a Christian burial ground, which can be applied to this object. This will make nearly £8 of the £80 or £100 needed.

Will it be possible for Australia to give us any assistance in this enterprise? If so, we will be most grateful for it. These poor people are generous givers, but they have very little to give, and, of course, we can not raise all, or even half of the amount required here. If you can do no more, pray for us, and for God's blessing upon the enterprise.

We are holding a good many street meetings in the Chinese quarter, and always have an interested and respectful audience. We also sell tracts and Scripture portions at such times.

We are much encouraged by the interest manifested, and thank God that we are in Sumatra, and can have a part in the work.

R. W. MUNSON.

Special Notice.

THE office of the Union Conference has been removed from 56 George Street West, Sydney, to 32 Royal Chambers, Castlereagh Street, Sydney. All communications for the officers of the Union Conference or for the UNION CONFERENCE RECORD should be sent in future to our new address. Please address the New South Wales Tract Society as formerly at 56 George Street West, Sydney.

Some Interesting Statistics.

FROM the *Review and Herald* of July 21, we give the following very interesting statistics, which were prepared by Pastor I. H. Evans, the Treasurer of the General Conference:—

In 1893 our reported total membership was 37,404. In 1903, just ten years later, our reported membership was 77,736—a gain in ten years of 40,332. Or, in other words, we had gained in ten years 2,928 more Sabbath-keepers than we had gained during all our previous existence.

In 1893, our offerings for missions had averaged for the previous five years, £14,050. In the five years preceding 1903, our offerings for mission work averaged £26,233. In the year 1903 it reached £36,805.

In 1892, the total tithe of all our people aggregated £60,462, while in 1902 it reached £128,749.

We have entered the following mission fields during this time: All of South Africa except Cape Colony; Nyassaland, the Gold Coast, German East Africa, Egypt, Palestine, Syria, India, China, Japan, and nearly all the Pacific Islands, South America, West Indies from Bermuda to Guiana, Central America, Mexico, Alaska, Manitoba, and nearly all of our mission stations outside of portions of Europe, have been entered during the past ten years. Never has there been such progress in all lines of the work as we can now behold.

If the next ten years see the same marked progress, and there is an equal increase in membership, there will be living on earth then more than 144,000 Seventh-day Adventists, scattered among the nations of earth. Our tithe will then have reached over £256,000 a year, while our offerings will have reached nearly £100,000 a year.

Is it a time now to sit in ease and quietness, or shall we join the worker's ranks, and be numbered with the Lord's host that goes up to possess the goodly land?

Results.

IT was into the same sea where the disciples had toiled all night and caught nothing, that the Saviour bade them cast their net. They drew safely to the land one hundred and fifty-three *great* fishes.

Do you believe you have done all you can for your neighbors, and yet see no fruit? Have you toiled in vain? If so, look about for the Saviour, you may have lost sight of Him. When your eyes are centred upon Him, He will direct you how to work successfully. It requires much prayer and humility to do efficient work. Scatter the publications, and follow them with your prayers. You will see fruit in the kingdom.—*Bible Training School.*

For Sale.

A WILLIAMS Typewriter; in perfect working order. Price £12. Apply to Australasian Union Conference, 32 Royal Chambers, Castlereagh Street, Sydney.